the minds of other men and acquire knowledge of the geography and the history of the world they live in. Does Western philosophy deny that the words of another can and do furnish the dark chamber of the mind with knowledge, in addition to the two windows of sensation and reflection with which Locke furnished the mind of man? This would be contrary to our daily experience. How could Western philosophy discuss the views of other philosophers as true or false, if it did not believe them to be the views of those philosophers? Through what source, if not testimony or authority, do we believe in the records of the historians of Buddha and Christ, or even of our own contemporaries when their words come to us through other reliable persons? While we do not accept what Aristotle said as true, do we not accept what he said as what *he* said? This is itself knowledge by testimony even when we have the words of the philosophers themselves as our guide. This means that both in India and in the West we believe in testimony as a valid means of knowledge. It is impossible to deny that one believes in signs like "danger ahead," "men at work," or "sharp curve," when one is driving on the road.

When Western philosophy denies testimony, it can mean either of two things: first, that testimony as such (no matter whose) is not the same thing as truth, because it can be false, or, second, that testimony is not an independent source of knowledge but is included in perception or inference. The first is a common ground between authority and any other source of knowledge, such as perception or reasoning, for perception or reasoning also (no matter whose) cannot be regarded as necessarily true. Western philosophy does not claim to believe in all perception and inference as true. If we are to disclaim authority on this score, we might as well not believe in perception and reasoning also for the same reason. Just as all cases of perception and reasoning cannot be true, although some will be true, similarly, while all authority may not be true, some will be. But how to determine which testimony is true and which false? The answer is that the truth of testimony is proved or disproved in the same way in which the truth of any other source of knowledge is proved. Perception or inference is proved true or false by correspondence or coherence or pragmatic tests. The same is the case with the words of authority, whether of a doctor or of a religious teacher. Why not, therefore, believe in authority along with perception and inference as a valid means of knowledge when the validity of knowledge in any case depends upon other conditions? Indian philosophy does no more than recognize that some authority is true exactly as some cases of reasoning and perception are true.